

HIGH SCHOOL BASKETBALL

FASTBREAK

High school hoops at a glance.



BILL KENNEDY / THE PD

Walsh Jesuit's Kyle Kolesar is fouled on his way to the basket by Hoban's Brandon Kurtz.

How they fared

BOYS

1. St. Vincent-St. Mary (9-0): Idle. Next: Tomorrow vs. Detroit Redford at CSU.
2. Central-Hower (8-0): Defeated Akron East, 66-49. Next: Tuesday vs. Akron North.
3. Benedictine (9-0): Idle. Next: Today vs. Admiral King.
4. Shaw (8-1): Defeated Normandy, 83-45. Next: Today vs. Warrensville Hts.
5. Olmsted Falls (10-0): Defeated Fairview, 82-50. Next: Friday vs. Amherst.
6. Cleveland Heights (7-2): Defeated Euclid, 65-40. Next: Tuesday vs. VASJ.
7. Brush (9-1): Defeated Solon, 67-63, 2 OTs. Next: Today vs. Eastlake North.
8. St. Edward (6-2): Idle. Next: Today vs. Shaker Hts.
9. Lakewood (8-2): Defeated Southview, 65-55. Next: Tomorrow vs. St. Edward.
10. Mentor (7-3): Defeated Shaker Hts., 85-81. Next: Tuesday vs. St. Vincent-St. Mary.
11. Cleveland East (10-1): Defeated Martin L. King, 84-73. Next: Tuesday vs. East Tech.
12. Glenville (7-2): Defeated Collinwood, 68-64. Next: Tuesday vs. Lincoln West.
13. St. Peter Chanel (8-2): Defeated Lake Catholic, 56-50. Next: Friday vs. Trinity.
14. Shaker Heights (5-4): Lost to Mentor, 85-81. Next: Today vs. St. Edward.
15. North Royalton (9-2): Defeated Midpark, 51-43. Next: Friday vs. North Ridgeville.
16. St. Ignatius (5-4): Defeated Findlay, 74-50. Next: Today vs. Westerville North.
17. Warrensville Heights (8-3): Idle. Next: Today vs. Shaker Hts.
18. Brunswick (10-1): Defeated Brecksville, 72-60. Next: Friday vs. Strongsville.
19. Wadsworth (9-0): Defeated Cloverleaf, 78-49. Next: Friday vs. Highland.
20. Archbishop Hoban (10-1): Defeated Walsh Jesuit, 67-54. Next: Tuesday vs. Cleveland C.C.
21. Elyria (7-3): Defeated Admiral King, 56-38. Next: Today vs. Parma.
22. Solon (9-2): Lost to Brush, 67-63, 2 OTs. Next: Tuesday vs. Stow.
23. Elyria Catholic (8-2): Defeated Padua, 56-42. Next: Friday vs. Cleveland C.C.
24. Rhodes (7-5): Defeated Max Hayes, 91-39. Next: Tuesday at Martin L. King.
25. Bedford (3-4): Idle. Next: Today vs. Maple Hts.

GIRLS

1. Regina (11-0): Idle. Next: Tomorrow versus No. 2 Villa-Angela-St. Joseph at CSU.
2. Villa Angela-St. Joseph (7-3): Idle. Next: Tomorrow versus No. 1 Regina at CSU.
3. Hudson (11-0): Idle. Next: Thursday vs. No. 18 Stow.
4. Shaw (9-0): Idle. Next: Today at Maple Heights.
5. Elyria (8-2): Idle. Next: Tonight vs. No. 7 Mentor.
6. Holy Name (10-0): Idle. Next: Tonight at No. 10 Padua.
7. Mentor (8-2): Idle. Next: Tonight at No. 5 Elyria.
8. Eastlake North (9-1): Idle. Next: Tuesday vs. Canton McKinley.
9. East Tech (6-2): Defeated John Marshall, 85-52. Next: Tuesday vs. Cleveland East at John Hay.
10. Padua (8-2): Idle. Next: Tonight vs. No. 6 Holy Name.
11. Copley (9-1): Idle. Next: Today vs. No. 23 Tallmadge.
12. Wadsworth (7-2): Idle. Next: Today vs. Highland.
13. Berea (8-4): Idle. Next: Tonight vs. Midpark.
14. Madison (10-3): Idle. Next: Today at Willoughby South.
15. Strongsville (11-1): Idle. Next: Tonight at Brunswick.
16. Archbishop Hoban (6-4): Idle. Next: Today at Akron North.
17. Walsh Jesuit (6-5): Lost to Keystone, 44-42. Next: Tonight at Keystown Ursuline.
18. Stow (10-1): Idle. Next: Tonight vs. Massillon.
19. Barberton (7-4): Idle. Next: Tuesday at Cuyahoga Falls.
20. Avon Lake (8-2): Idle. Next: Today vs. Olmsted Falls.
21. St. Peter Chanel (6-4): Idle. Next: Monday vs. No. 22 Trinity.
22. Trinity (7-3): Idle. Next: Monday at No. 21 St. Peter Chanel.
23. Tallmadge (9-3): Idle. Next: Today vs. No. 11 Copley.
24. Brooklyn (11-1): Idle. Next: Today at Columbia.
25. Twinsburg (8-3): Idle. Next: Thursday at Nardonla.

BOYS BASKETBALL

Cardinals too much for Teague, Raiders

MIKE PETICCA
Plain Dealer Reporter

Mentor got a full dose of Anthony Teague last night, and Tuesday night, it gets LeBron James. The Cardinals would be thrilled with identical results.

Teague, Shaker Heights' 6-5 forward, scored 39 points but couldn't prevent host Mentor from earning an 85-81 victory. Mentor (7-3, 3-2 in the Lake Erie League's Lake Division) will take a six-game winning streak into its game against James-led St. Vincent-St. Mary at the University of Akron.

"We really wanted to go in [to the SVSM game] with the right mindset," Mentor coach Bob Krizancic said. "Winning this game was big."

#10 MENTOR
#14 SHAKER HEIGHTS

05
01

Teague, who has accepted a basketball scholarship from Division I Radford, made 12 of 19 field-goal attempts — including 3 of 4 3-point shots — and 12 of 14 free throws. He scored 29 of his points during a 12-minute span of the second half.

Mentor, one of the area's deepest teams, got 32 points from its bench. Ten Cardinals scored in the first three quarters as they built leads as big as 19 points.

Guard Eddie Zienkowski led Mentor with 21 points, actually dropping his scoring average to 25.8 points. Guard Jay Reichert hit four 3-point shots and scored all of his 15 points in the first 2 1/2

quarters. Forward Nick Meyer also tallied 15 points, including four foul shots in the final 1:15, after Teague's 3-point play had cut the Mentor lead to 79-74.

"There are 12 guys, and that's the key for us," Reichert said. "Because of the penetration of our other guys, Shaker was sagging off and leaving me open. They were still leery of Eddie and Nick. I wasn't one of the guys they were worried about at the start of the game."

Mentor's trademark is the 3-point shot, along with an aggressive defense that can turn opponents' mistakes into easy baskets at the other end. Last night, the Cardinals canned 13 of 32 3-pointers and forced 21 Raiders turnovers.

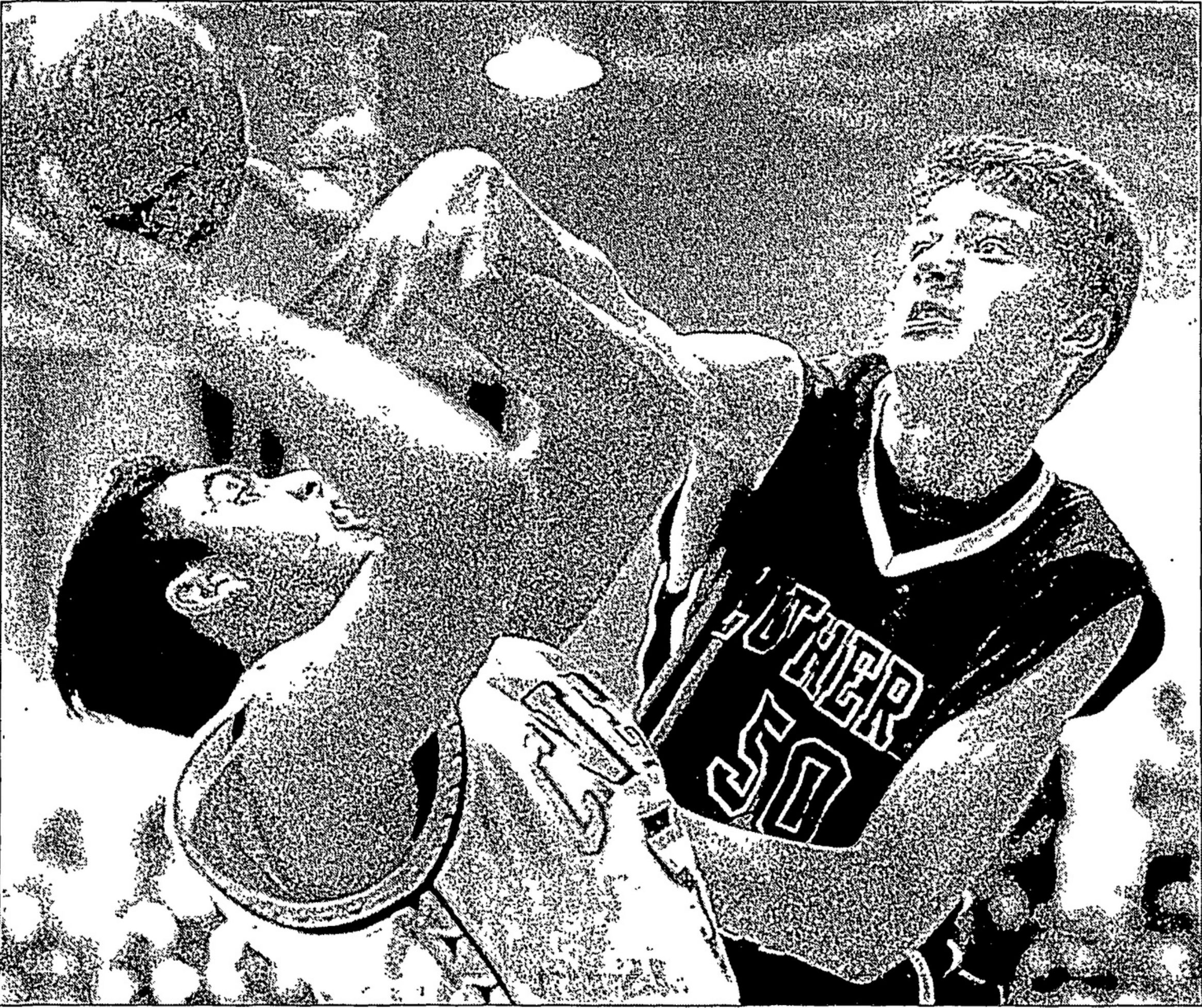
Forward Paul Sadler totaled 11 points

and 10 rebounds for defending Lake Division champion Shaker Heights (5-4, 3-2). Teague, now averaging 21.7 points, proved again that he can score from inside or outside, or with a silky medium-range jump shot.

"He's one of the premier players in Greater Cleveland," Raiders coach Bob Wonson said. "He's one of the best we've had at Shaker, and we've had some good ones."

The 6-1 Zienkowski hit 5 of 12 3-pointers. He, Meyer and frontcourt standout Mark Martucci ran into foul trouble, but the Cardinals' depth paid off.

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SCOTT SHAW / THE PLAIN DEALER

Lutheran West's Richard Semrau, right, fouls Brooklyn's Dominick Grassi in the second quarter last night.

Handling the pressure

Hurricanes grab first place behind Grassi's 27 points

EDDIE DWYER
Plain Dealer Reporter

BROOKLYN
LUTHERAN WEST

65
55

You don't win back-to-back conference championships without being able to respond when the pressure is on.

Brooklyn's Hurricanes, who are seeking their third consecutive MAC-8 title, weathered the storm again last night and now find themselves alone in first place.

The Hurricanes, behind a game-high 27 points by junior forward Dominick Grassi, withstood a late rally by Lutheran West and defeated the Longhorns, 65-55, in a MAC-8 boys basketball game at Brooklyn.

Getting two key layups from senior forward Jamie Deluca in the final two minutes and some clutch free-throw shooting by Grassi down the stretch, the Hurricanes improved to 8-3, 7-1 in the MAC-8. Lutheran West, which cut an 18-point deficit to six points with just over a minute left, slipped to 5-5, 5-2.

"We knew Lutheran West was going to make a run at some point," said Brooklyn

coach Jeff Shepherd, whose team led, 46-28, entering the fourth quarter. "They have the 3-point shooters and they're extremely well-coached. But the bottom line was that we were able to make baskets against their pressure when we needed to. And Dom [Grassi] did a real nice job at the [four] line."

With Grassi scoring 15 points on an assortment of perimeter jumpers and strong moves to the basket, the Hurricanes went on a 9-0 run late in the first quarter and held a 29-20 lead at halftime.

In the third quarter, Hurricanes' junior guard Nick Latimer began to heat up from a 3-point range and Brooklyn appeared to be sailing.

However, after a driving one-hander by junior guard Kyle Petkac gave the Hurricanes the 18-point cushion, Lutheran West picked up its defensive pressure in the final eight minutes.

A soft jumper in the lane and a reverse one-handed layup by Longhorns junior

guard Ruben Davila trimmed the deficit to 49-39 with 4:58 left.

Senior Tyler Minnick's third 3-pointer enabled Lutheran West to close to 57-49 with 2:25 remaining and, after a soft baseline jumper by 6-8 freshman Richard Semrau, the Longhorns trailed, 59-53, with 1:18 to play.

But Brooklyn was able to sandwich in the two layups by Deluca, who finished with 16 points, and sealed the victory behind Grassi's free throws. Grassi, who has made 20 of his last 23 free throws, was 11-of-14 from the line.

"It got a little hectic and we got some blood flowing there at the end," said Lutheran West coach Phil Argento, whose team was 5-of-10 from the free-throw line compared to 22-of-31 for Brooklyn. "And there were a couple of times when we had the ball and could have cut it down even further. But they didn't give up the lead against our pressure, and that's to their credit."

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BOYS ROUNDUP

Keystone junior scores 54

From staff reports

Keystone's Brett Bartlett had the linescore of a lifetime last night in an 83-64 boys basketball win over Oberlin.

Bartlett, a junior guard, hit 18 field goals and 15 free throws to finish with 54 points. Three of his baskets were 3-pointers.

Jordan Beard scored 29 points to lead Oberlin.

Central-Hower 66, Akron East 49 Jeremiah Wood was a one-man wrecking crew last night in an Akron City Series game.

The senior center nearly pulled off a triple-double as The Plain Dealer's second-ranked team won at home. Wood scored 22 points to go with 18 rebounds and nine blocked shots. His performance helped the Eagles (8-0, 6-0) out rebound the Orientals, 37-18. Classmate Dejuan Dennis had 10 rebounds and 19 points.

Kimani Smith led East (4-6, 3-3) with 15 points.

Brunswick 72, Brecksville 60 Brecksville senior Grant Urbanski scored 23 points in the first half and finished with 33 on the night, but it wasn't enough to overcome the hosts' balance in a Pioneer Conference game. Brunswick (10-1, 6-1) got 18 points apiece from Jeff Boggs and Nick Scheutow. Scheutow, a senior, also had 12 rebounds and three blocked shots.

Cleveland Hts. 65, Euclid 40 Cleveland Heights was trailing, 26-25, at halftime when veteran coach Jim Cappelletti gave a fiery pep talk.

Then, the host Tigers stormed to a Lake Erie League Lake Division win, as senior guard Jon Battle scored a game-high 35 points. The performance marked the third time Battle has scored 35 or more, the others coming against Mentor and Lima.

The Tigers (7-2, 5-0) are ranked sixth by The Plain Dealer. Euclid dropped to 1-9, 1-4.

St. Peter Chanel 56, Lake Catholic 50 Lake Catholic's Rob Hrusovsky scored a game-high 20 points, but the visiting Firebirds held on in the fourth quarter for a North Coast League win. Keith DeVaughn had 15 points to lead the Firebirds, and Austin Weatherington scored 10.

St. Peter Chanel (8-2, 3-0) is ranked 13th by The Plain Dealer.

Olmsted Falls 82, Fairview 50 Steve Gansey made four 3-pointers and finished with 28 points, and teammate Dan Bingeli scored 25 as the Bulldogs stayed unbeaten with a Southwestern Conference road victory. Falls is 10-0 and ranked fifth by The Plain Dealer. R.J. Dieringer led Fairview (5-5) with 13 points.

Elyria Catholic 56, Padua 42 The Panthers held Padua to two points in the first quarter and scored a North Coast League win in Parma. Jake Ballosky scored 18 points to lead EC (8-2, 6-1). Teammate Jason Smith had 15. EC is ranked 23rd by The Plain Dealer.

Cleveland East 84, MLK 73 DeAunty Scott, a senior guard, scored 26 points, and the Bombers held off Martin Luther King in a Senate game. East, ranked 11th by The Plain Dealer, led by 17 points at halftime.

CARL MATZELLE
Plain Dealer Reporter

STOW
HUDSON

62
38

The Stow Bulldogs barked and bit their way through the Hudson Explorers, 62-38, last night in a Western Reserve Conference matchup at Hudson.

The Bulldogs (9-1, 5-0 WRC) were stilling on defense, allowing only two points in the first quarter, a layup by sophomore forward Connor Reilly.

Stow scored the last 13 points of the quarter and the first eight points in the second quarter for a 21-0 run that ended when Hudson junior guard Mike Kassouf hit a baseline jumper with 5:55 to play in the first half.

The Explorers (4-6, 2-3) trailed, 16-2, after one quarter and 30-14 at halftime.

"Leads like that are both good and bad news," said Stow coach David Close. "I was worried that we'd get complacent and lose our intensity."

Hudson played better in the second

half as junior guard Matt Freedman scored 11 of his team-leading 16 points in the third quarter. Freedman hit four 3-point shots in the game — one at the buzzer to end the third quarter — but it wasn't enough to spark a legitimate comeback.

"I thought we'd play up to the level of our competition, but we were just going through the motions early in the game," said Freedman. "Stow took advantage of it, and we couldn't dig ourselves out."

Stow senior forward Will McGinley led all scorers with 17 points, including three 3-pointers, and senior guard Kendrick Watson scored 13.

"Most of my points tonight came off the fast break," said Watson. "But as a point guard, I try to get everyone involved in the game."

Close said: "Watson and McGinley are

both lettermen, and we expect them to contribute, but we're a balanced team with other capable players."

Stow junior center Brian Flaherty had 10 points and pulled down eight rebounds, and senior guard Adam Trent had 10 points and four rebounds.

"I always feel like I'm in a zone out there," said McGinley, who pulled down six rebounds. "We hustled and took advantage of some of Hudson's early mistakes."

Hudson turned the ball over 18 times to 12 for Stow.

Explorers coach Wayne Watts was gracious in defeat, although he was a little upset with the last-minute transition points his team allowed.

"We were in over our heads before we knew it," Watts said. "Stow's a very good veteran team, and they showed it."

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